FUTURE READY™ · AMBASSADOR CHRISTIAN SCHOOL

FROM POSSIBILITY TO OPPORTUNITY

Career Exploration · Pathways · Relationships · Taking Initiative

WEEK 5

WEEK 5 AT A GLANCE

- Theme: FROM POSSIBILITY TO OPPORTUNITY
- Career Exploration · Pathways · Relationships · Taking Initiative
- Essential Question: How do I move from wondering what is possible to actually learning about and creating opportunities?
- Purpose: Move students from passive career curiosity to active opportunity-building through exploration, relationships, questions, evidence, and one concrete next move.
- 50-minute class design: fast-moving, discussion-based, team-oriented, and built around real-world application.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Identify multiple pathways connected to interests, strengths, experiences, and emerging curiosity.
- Distinguish a job title from a pathway and recognize that careers are built through experiences, skills, relationships, and decisions.
- Practice asking a professional for a short learning conversation rather than asking for a job.
- Prepare a purposeful question for a former-athlete professional experience.
- Capture evidence that can carry into the Future Ready™ Passport, portfolio, and Beyond the Game capstone.

50-MINUTE FACILITATOR FLOW

- 0-5 min — OPEN: Quick movement prompt: students choose a side of the room for 'I know exactly what I want to do' vs. 'I am still exploring.' Debrief: both are valid starting points.
- 5-12 min — POSSIBILITY ≠ OPPORTUNITY: Discuss the difference between knowing something exists and taking action to learn about it.
- 12-22 min — OPPORTUNITY MAP: Students map interests/strengths → possible roles/industries → people/places that could help them learn → one action.
- 22-32 min — PATHWAY CHALLENGE: Teams receive the same end goal and different assets. They build and defend a route to the goal, emphasizing collaboration and decision-making.
- 32-40 min — RELATIONSHIP PRACTICE: Students build and rehearse a 30-second opportunity ask for an informational conversation.
- 40-46 min — FORMER-ATHLETE PREP: Students prepare the future-self question and one personal follow-up question.
- 46-50 min — EVIDENCE + CLOSE: Students record one pathway to explore, one person to learn from, and one next move.

FACILITATOR OPENING

- Say: 'Today is not about choosing the one career you will have forever. It is about learning how opportunities actually get created.'
- Ask: 'What is the difference between saying “that sounds interesting” and actually learning whether it fits you?'

- Reinforce: exploration is action. A conversation, visit, question, project, introduction, or research step can turn possibility into evidence.

ACTIVITY 1 — OPPORTUNITY MAP

- Students complete four zones: What interests me; What I already bring; Where this could show up; Who/what can help me learn.
- Require at least three possible roles or pathways, not one 'dream job.'
- Require at least two real people, organizations, workplaces, programs, or experiences that could help them learn more.
- Close with one action that can happen within seven days.

ACTIVITY 2 — SAME GOAL, DIFFERENT ASSETS

- Divide the class into two or more teams. Give every team the same end goal: create a credible path for a student to learn whether a career field is a fit.
- Give each team different assets: example assets include a coach connection, alumni contact, local employer, school counselor, LinkedIn, volunteer role, job shadow, community event, professor, teammate's parent, or industry association.
- Teams have 6 minutes to build the strongest route using only their assigned assets, then 60 seconds to present.
- Debrief the collaboration: Who listened? Who organized? Who challenged assumptions? What made the plan credible?

ACTIVITY 3 — 30-SECOND OPPORTUNITY ASK

- Structure: who I am → what I am exploring → why I chose this person → a small, specific ask.
- Example framework: 'Hi, I'm ____. I'm a student athlete exploring ____. I'm interested in how you got into ____. Would you be willing to give me 15 minutes sometime to ask a few questions about your path?'
- Students practice twice. Round 1 is natural. Round 2 incorporates peer feedback for clarity, confidence, specificity, and professionalism.

FORMER-ATHLETE PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE — PRE / DURING / POST

- PRE: Every student prepares this anchor question: "What is something I should start building now, while I am still an athlete, that my future self will be grateful I built?"
- PRE: Add one personal question about transition, identity, career exploration, relationships, failure, preparation, or decisions.
- DURING: Capture one statement that challenged your thinking, one action the speaker took that created opportunity, and one question you still have.
- POST: Translate the conversation into evidence: What did I learn? What applies to me? What will I do next?

REFLECTION + EVIDENCE

- Reflection: What careers or pathways interest you right now, and why?
- Evidence: One pathway I will explore further.
- Evidence: One relationship or informational conversation I can pursue.
- Evidence: One next move I will make.
- Beyond the Game connection: Who am I becoming beyond the game?

ASSESSMENT

- Evidence of exploration — student identifies more than one plausible pathway.
- Initiative — student identifies a concrete next move rather than a vague intention.

- Professional communication — student can make a concise, respectful opportunity ask.
- Relationship awareness — student understands networking as learning and relationship-building, not simply asking for a job.
- Reflection/evidence — student captures learning that can be reused in Passport, portfolio, and capstone.

MATERIALS

- Week 5 Student Workbook
- Opportunity Map
- Same Goal, Different Assets team cards
- 30-Second Opportunity Ask practice card
- Former-Athlete PRE / DURING / POST note catcher
- Week 5 Portfolio Artifact
- Pens/pencils; optional sticky notes; no screen required.

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